

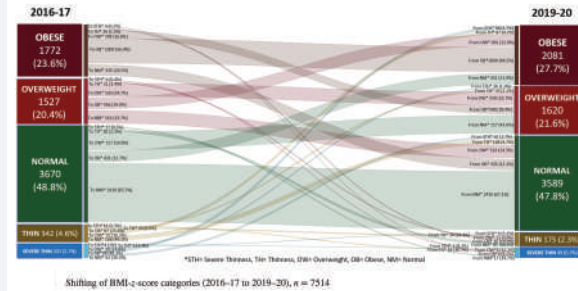
SE7ATY صحتي

TO ADDRESS CHILDHOOD OBESITY IN QATAR

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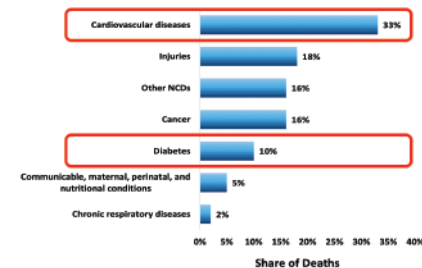
FACT FINDINGS

School children growth monitoring program in 2016–17 and 2019–20



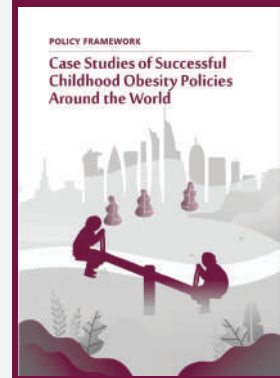
The figure illustrates the growth of school children obesity in Qatar from **2016** to **2020**

Distribution of Deaths in Qatar in 2019, By Cause



Source: Statista 2023
Most clinical studies have shown that childhood obesity is linked to diseases like diabetes and cardiovascular. Therefore, childhood obesity is a public health issue, and the population's overall health status can be assessed using its obesity rates

MoPH Policy Framework



PROBLEM

Childhood Obesity Epidemic in Qatar

MAIN TARGET



Kindergarten and Primary School
(1st – 6th grader) Students

CURRENT SITUATION

- » In the range of 2019-2020, **27.7%** school children in Qatar were obese (Al-Thani et al., 2023)
- » **MOPH:**
 - » Introduced a policy framework (2020) to tackle obesity but they do not have a tool to monitor and evaluate the program
 - » Introduced standard physical activity in the school's curriculum
 - » Banned unhealthy food and beverages in schools

PROPOSED SOLUTIONS

- » Application that helps parents and schools to monitor and evaluate the children's health
- » The application will be part of the existing curriculum
- » Allow the parents to input data about children's nutrition facts

BENEFICIARIES

- » The students of Primary School & Kindergarten
- » The parents of Primary School & Kindergarten Students



STAKEHOLDERS



INPUTS



» Budget

» Stipulate a minimum standard of healthy foods, beverages, and standard exercise for children

» **3** developers for the mobile applications for **6** months

» **2** technicians to maintain the mobile application

» **20** consultants/nutritionists per month

» Appoint **1** representative per school as coordinator with family

» **2** curriculum specialists

OUTPUTS

- » A minimum standard of healthy foods, beverages, and standard exercise for children
- » Children's Lifestyle application
- » The number of children and parents
- » The number of schools and teachers
- » More than **200** thousand times applications downloaded
- » **160** hours of coaching hours
- » **80** hours of free consultation
- » Report from nutritionist future project
- » A large database of children's lifestyles to support the health statistics
- » Growth monitoring and progress tracking for each child

THE BUDGET NEEDS

The Types of Need	Total Price (QAR)	Description
Building a Health Application	100,000	The government build a health application
Maintenance of The Application	120,000	Cost of maintenance per year: Two people with each salary QAR 5,000 per month
Digital Weight and Height Scale	1,257,000	The government distributes free Digital Weight and Height Scale at the beginning of the program - For the sustainability of the program, the government allocate some money yearly for giving reward to the students - Assumptions: 1. The toys/books distributed semi-annually 2. 80% of the students can achieve the goals
Reward (Books or Toys)	16,484,080	
Certificate for the best achiever	3,786	for the best three achiever every year
Certificate of appreciation	329,682	Assumptions: 1. For every student who achieve the score 80 and above (yearly) 2. 80% of the students can achieve the goals
Total	18,294,548	

Calculation Reference: MoEHE Annual Statistics 2021

PHASES OF IMPLEMENTATION

Phase I: Planning

- Policy assessment
- Meetings with the government (MoPH, MoEHE)
- Meetings with representatives of the schools and parents
- Obtaining the government's approval
- Launching lifestyle application

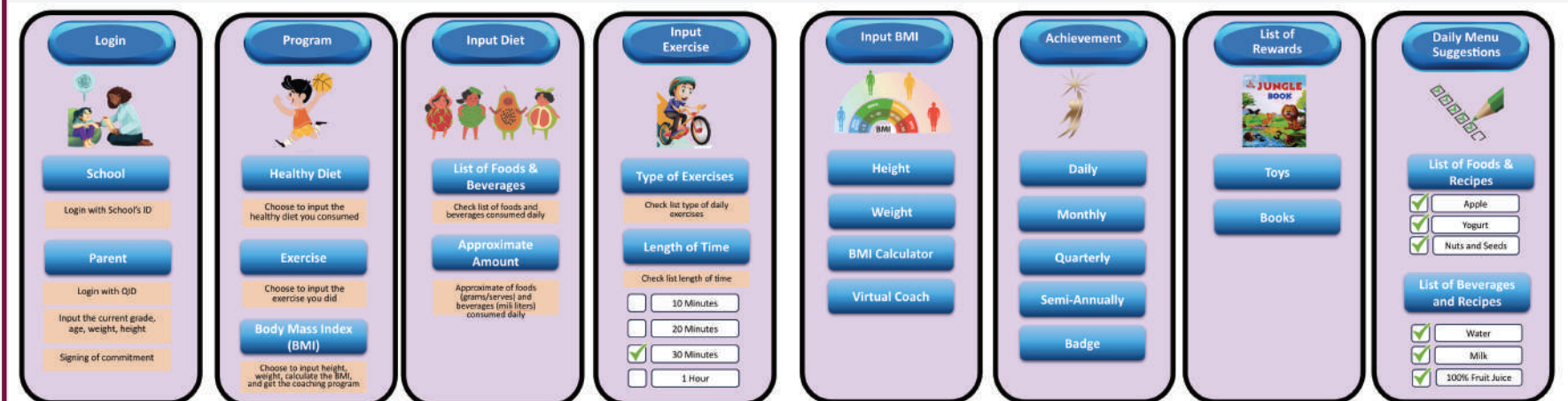
Phase II: Disseminating & Piloting

- The government circulates the program, guidance, and application to all schools
- The respective school disseminates guidance and application to the parents
- Involve **513** students from each schools (total: **1539**)
 - Abdullah Al Musnad primary school for boys
 - Sakinah primary school for girls
 - Doha British School Al-Wakra
- Evaluate the effectiveness of the application

Phase III: Implementing

- Involve all schools in Qatar to use the application
- Request the parents and schools to sign the online commitment through the application
- Input daily food consumption and the exercise to the application by parents
- Input children's weight and height by teacher monthly
- Free consultation sessions with health experts & nutritionists
- Evaluate the result quarterly
- Send the report to the stakeholders

APPLICATION DESIGN



SHORT TERM OUTCOMES

- » Increase awareness of family members about healthy eating behavior
- » Improve a healthy lifestyle among children in Qatar
- » Reduce obesity-related diseases of children by **30%** from **27.7%** to **20%**

LONG TERM OUTCOMES



- » Reduce obesity-related diseases of children by **50%** from **20%** to **10%**
- » Reduce death rates caused by diseases triggered by obesity (cardiovascular and diabetes) when they become adults



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